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/ **Practice Exam - 1**

Correct Answer

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Practice Exam - 1

Question 112 of 117



A 45-year-old man presents with concerns about personal risk for heart failure because his father was diagnosed with HF after a myocardial infarction at age 72. His medical history includes HTN and DM. Medications include metformin 1000mg twice daily, lisinopril 10mg daily, and amlodipine 10mg daily. Patient smokes ½ pack per day for 15 years, but does not drink alcohol or use recreational drugs. He reports he does not exercise on a regular basis but walks 5 blocks and climbs 3 flights of stairs with no activity related limitations. On examination patient vital signs are: blood pressure is 148/78 mmHg, heart rate is 92 beats per minute, respiratory rate is 16/min, oxygen saturation 98% on room air, BMI 39 Kg/m2. Patient appears comfortable, lungs are clear. Cardiovascular exam is normal. Pulses are palpable in all extremities.

In addition to intensifying anti-hypertensive regimen, counseling on tobacco cessation and lifestyle modifications, which is the next appropriate step in reducing the risk of future heart failure in this patient?



A. Obtain BNP or NT proBNP



B. Refer for weight loss surgery

C. Obtain an exercise treadmill test

D. Refer for a computerized tomography of the chest

Commentary

References

Testing point: Heart Failure Prevention.

Answer: A. Obtain BNP or NT-proBNP

Natriuretic peptides can be used to identify patients at risk of developing HF, particularly in the setting of risk factors, such as seen in this patient. In the 2023 ACC/AHA/HFSA Guidelines for the Management of Heart Failure, BNP testing in such a patient receives a 2a indication. Identification of a patient at risk should be followed by shared decision making and risk factor modification, optimally utilizing team-based care including a cardiovascular specialist to implement guideline-directed medical therapy (GDMT) for stages A/B HF to prevent the development of left ventricular dysfunction (systolic or diastolic) or new-onset HF.

Answer: B. Refer for weight loss surgery. Bariatric surgery should be considered for adults with a BMI >40 kg/m² or a BMI >35 kg/m² with obesity-related comorbid conditions who are motivated to lose weight and who have not responded to behavioral treatment (with or without pharmacotherapy) with sufficient weight loss to achieve targeted health outcome goals. This patient's motivation to lose weight has not been assessed, and he has not yet engaged in behavioral and pharmacologic weight loss treatment.

Answer C: Obtain an exercise treadmill test. The patient exercises to a moderate level on a regular basis without symptoms, and stress testing is not indicated. Answer D:- Refer for a computerized tomography of the chest CT may be indicated to screen for lung cancer in a symptomatic patient with a significant smoking history, but has no role in HF prevention.

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